

PING!

SLACK
#general
17 new messages

URGENT!

EMAIL
12 new messages
3 flagged

CALENDAR
10:00 AM
Team Meeting

47 TABS OPEN

Pick up
dry cleaning

Call Mom

NEED
MORE
COFFEE

OVERWHELM!

SURVIVING DAILY CHAOS IN SPITE OF YOURSELF:

PROVEN DAILY HACKS FOR ADHD

✓ FOCUS
✓ PLAN
✓ EXECUTE
✓ REVIEW
BULLET JOURNAL

TODAY
1. DEEP WORK
2. CLIENT PROJECT
3. EXERCISE
4. EMAIL
5. PLAN TOMORROW
FOCUS > PRODUCTION
NOT PERFECT

ONE STEP.
ONE MINUTE.
ONE CHOICE.



Time to focus!

PHONE
23 Notifications

NEW
IDEA!

LEARN
GUITAR?

RABBIT
HOLE!

CONTEXT
SWITCH!

LAUNDRY
...AGAIN

DON'T
FORGET!

HALF-FINISHED
PROJECTS

- ☐ Podcast
- ☐ Course
- ☐ Book
- ☐ App
- ☐ YouTube Channel

<DevSum>

Cornerstone

active
SOLUTION

Polisen

RaySearch
Laboratories

Skatteverket

Slides, resources, templates, and updates



<https://github.com/JRAlexander/surviving-chaos-with-adhd-hacks-devsum-26>

A quick question:



How many browser tabs do you have open?

3:55 PM Thu May 28



Private

2,532 Tabs

My best friend has ADHD.
Current tab count: 2,532



Level Lock Pro | Level



Does This Sound Familiar?

- unfinished projects
- browser tabs
- sticky notes
- rabbit holes
- forgotten tasks
- "I'll do it later"

Why listen to me?

- ADHD
- Traumatic Brain Injury
- CTO
- Ex-Microsoft
- Oxford AI Instructor
- Conference Speaker
- Entrepreneur

The Real Problem Isn't Attention

PREFRONTAL CORTEX



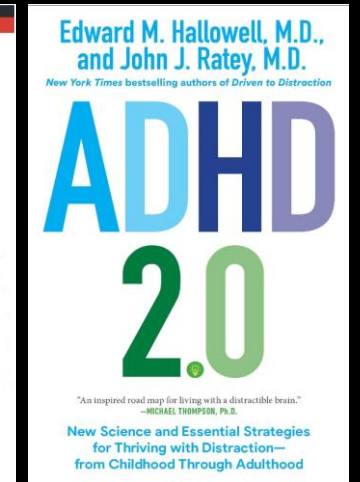
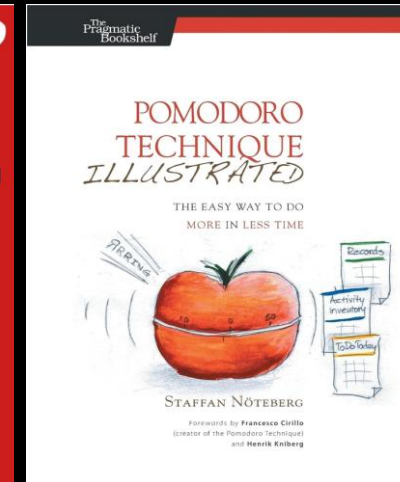
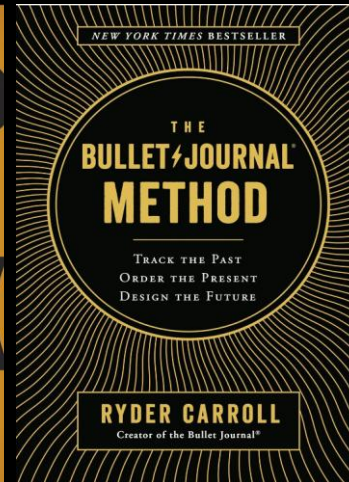
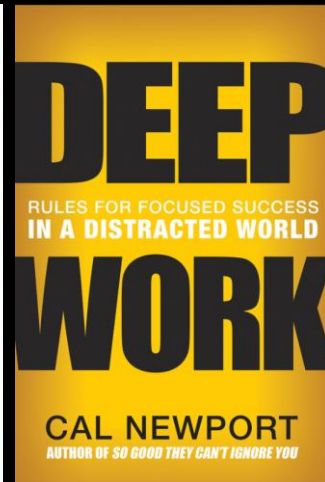
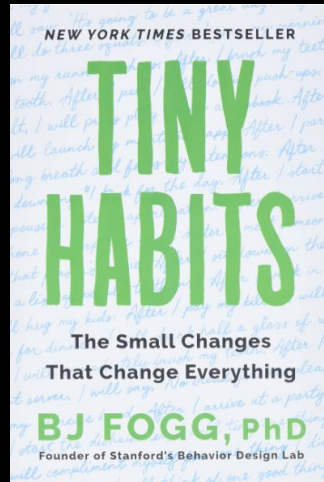
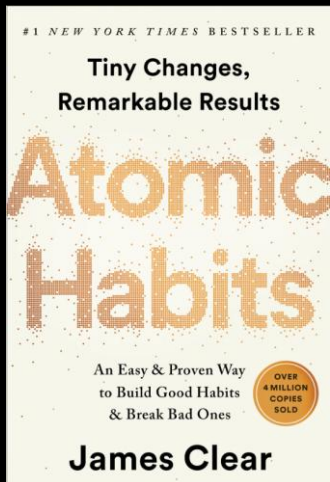
- Planning
- Prioritization
- Working memory
- Task initiation
- Task switching
- Emotional regulation

It's Executive Function

The ADHD Engineering Principle

- My brain is brilliant but unreliable.
- Externalize:
 - Memory
 - Process
 - Time
 - Planning
 - Recovery

My Workflow Foundations



ACT I: THE WEIRD HACKS

How Can Paul Simon Save Resources?

Albumodoro – Lee Brandt

- Pomodoro
- Albumodoro
- Shower Playlists
- If you struggle to feel time, borrow somebody else's clock.

Can Putting Running Shoes In The Way Help You Exercise?

Tiny Habits

Atomic Habits

- Reduce friction
- Make starting easy
- Make good habits obvious

Can A Vegetable Make You More Accurate?

- **Pomodoro**
 - 25/5
 - 50/10
 - Focus Sprint
 - Stop Point
- Clocks everywhere

Can Making An X Keep You Going?

Seinfeld Streak Calendar

- Worked
- Then stopped working

Act II: THE FRAMEWORK

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New message

23

NEW
IDEA!

Just
check this
one thing...

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EMAIL
Re: Re: URGENT

RABBIT
HOLE!

12 TABS OPEN

Don't
forget!

CONTEXT
SWITCH!

CALENDAR
Another meeting
in 15 min

HALF-FINISHED
PROJECTS

MISSION CONTROL

PRIORITIES

1. DEEP WORK
2. CLIENT PROJECT
3. HEALTH

NEXT ACTION

Send proposal

CURRENT POMODORO

3 of 4

21:36

EXECUTIVE FUNCTION ASSIST SYSTEM

BULLET JOURNAL

- Capture
- Organize
- Clarify
- Track

CONNECTION



The real power source.
Reminds me I'm not
doing this alone.

SPOUSE



YOU GOT
THIS.

BEST FRIEND



I'M HERE.

ACCOUNTABILITY PARTNER



LET'S
DO THIS.

COMMUNITY



WE'VE
GOT YOU.

THIS ISN'T A CURE.
IT'S AN

EXOSKELETON.

DESIGNED TO COMPENSATE FOR EXECUTIVE FUNCTION CHALLENGES
SO I CAN DO WHAT MATTERS.



CHECKLISTS

External memory
for what matters.



DEEP WORK

Protects focus
from distraction.



POMODORO TIMER

Structure time.
Sustain focus.



TOMORROW PLANNING

End the day.
Start tomorrow
with clarity.



ATOMIC HABITS

Build systems.
Make good habits
inevitable.



MOVEMENT & HEALTH

Fuel the brain.
Regulate energy.
Improve everything.

WHAT IT DOES

- ✓ REDUCES OVERWHELM
- ✓ IMPROVES FOCUS
- ✓ BUILDS MOMENTUM

- ✓ CREATES CLARITY
- ✓ SUPPORTS FOLLOW-THROUGH
- ✓ DESIGNS A LIFE THAT WORKS
WITH MY BRAIN, NOT AGAINST IT

NOT SUPERHUMAN.

JUST SUPPORTED.

1

DEEP WORK HELMET

HOW DO I PROTECT FOCUS?



Answer:

- AirPods
- Instrumental music
- One goal (one thing at a time)
- Reduced interruptions
- Reduced context switching
- Designated time for slack / email

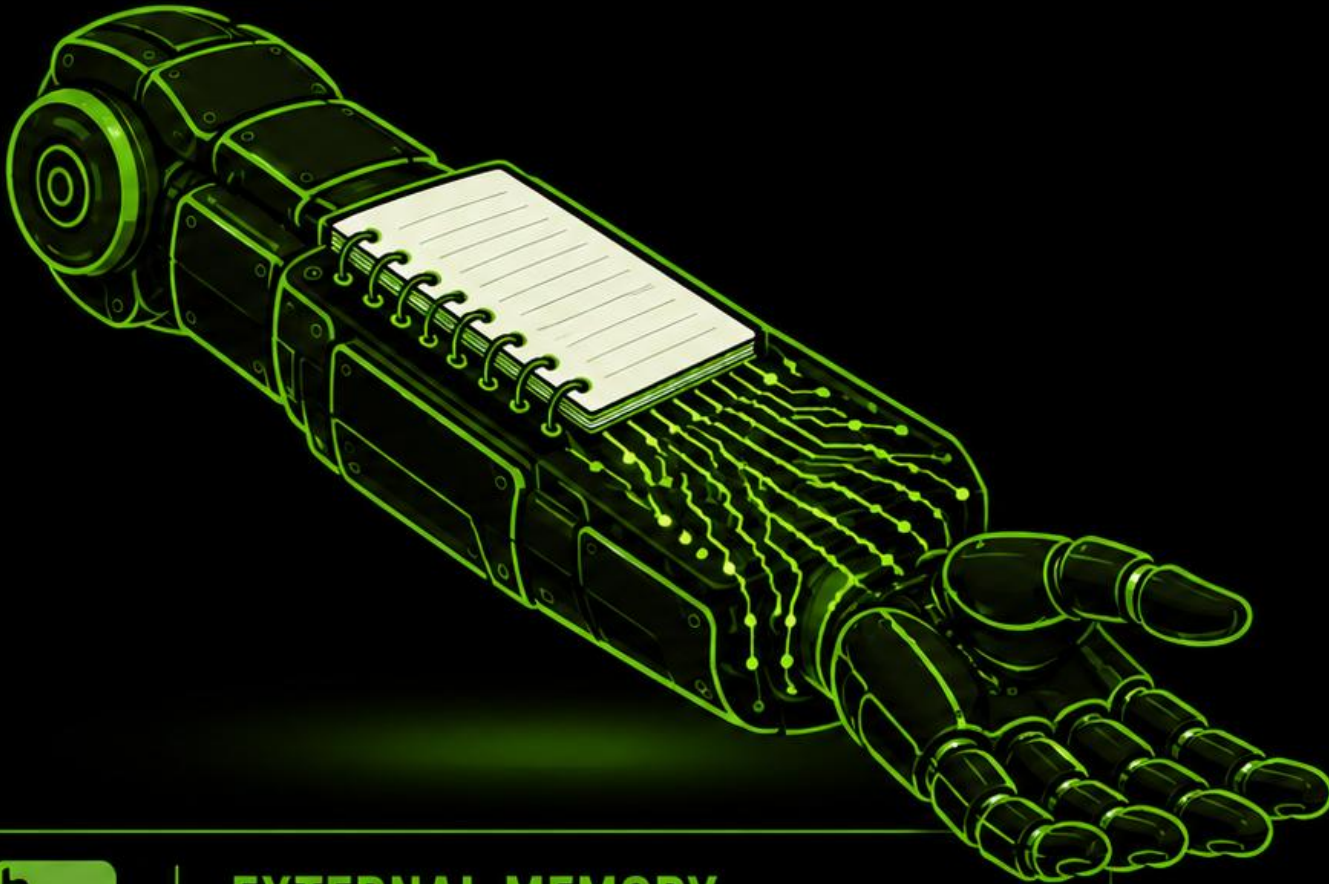


**PROTECT ATTENTION.
MINIMIZE CONTEXT SWITCHING.**

2

BULLET JOURNAL ARM

HOW DO I REMEMBER?



Answer:

- Capture everything
- External memory
- Brain dump
- Trusted system



**EXTERNAL MEMORY
FOR AN UNRELIABLE MEMORY.**

3

BIG BOY POMODORO REGULATOR

HOW DO I START?



Answer:

- One Pomodoro
- One album
- One commitment
- Just begin



START THE *TIMER* (OR *ALBUM*). START THE *WORK*.

4

CHECKLIST CORE

HOW DO I AVOID MISTAKES?



Answer:

- Reusable process
- Reduce working-memory load
- Don't remember
- Verify



DON'T REMEMBER. **VERIFY.**

5

PLANNING REACTOR

HOW DO I REDUCE DECISIONS?



Answer:

- Decide tonight
- Execute tomorrow
- Reduce decision load
- Externalize executive function



EXTERNALIZE DECISIONS.

6

MOMENTUM ENGINES

HOW DO I KEEP MOVING?



Answer:

- Tiny habits
- Reduce friction
- Create momentum
- Keep the wheels turning

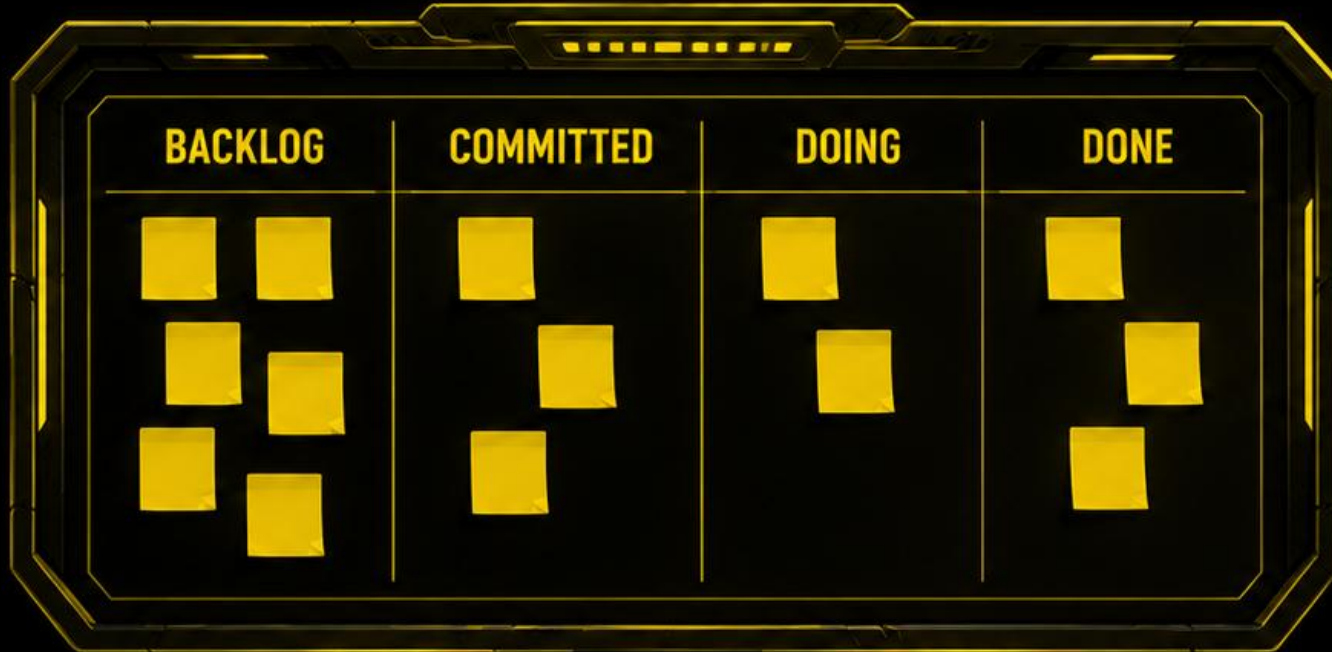


SMALL ACTIONS. CONTINUOUS MOVEMENT.



MISSION CONTROL

HOW DO I SEE THE WORK?



Answer:

- Kanban board
- Visual workflow

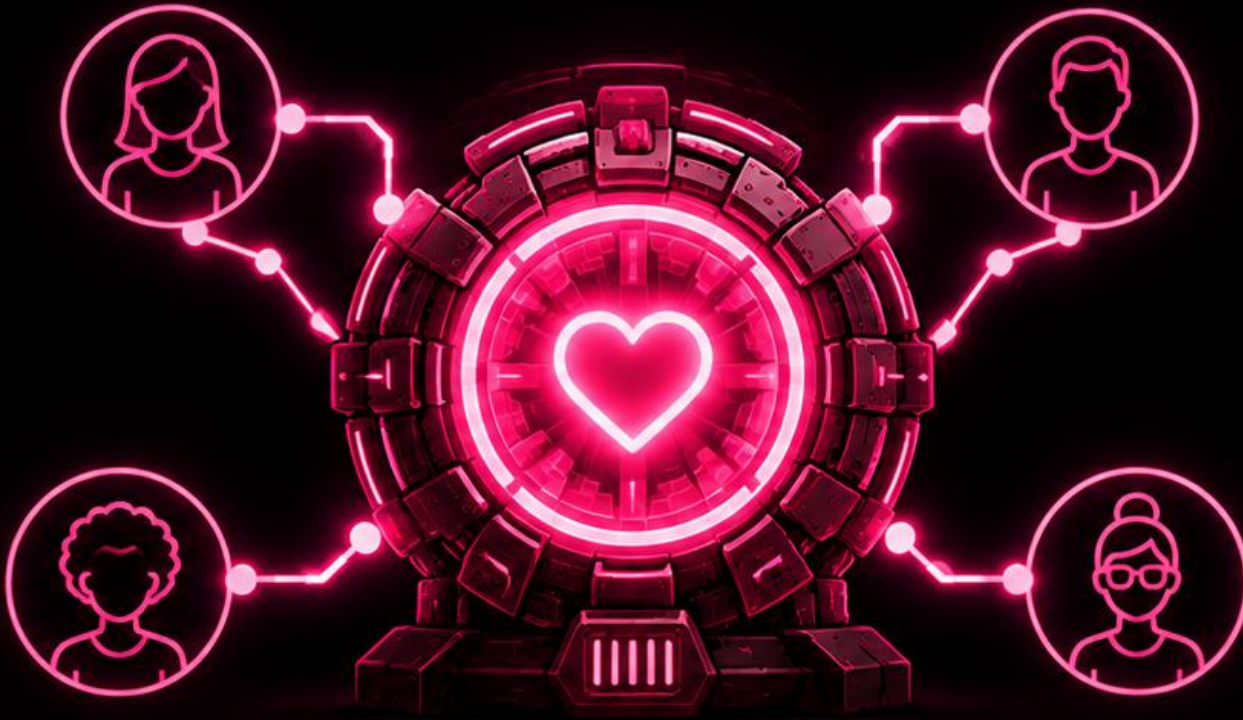


IF EVERYTHING IS IMPORTANT, NOTHING IS.

8

CONNECTION CORE

HOW DO I STAY SUPPORTED?



Answer:

- Family
- Community
- Accountability
- Humor
- Vitamin C



CONNECTION IS MY POWER SOURCE.

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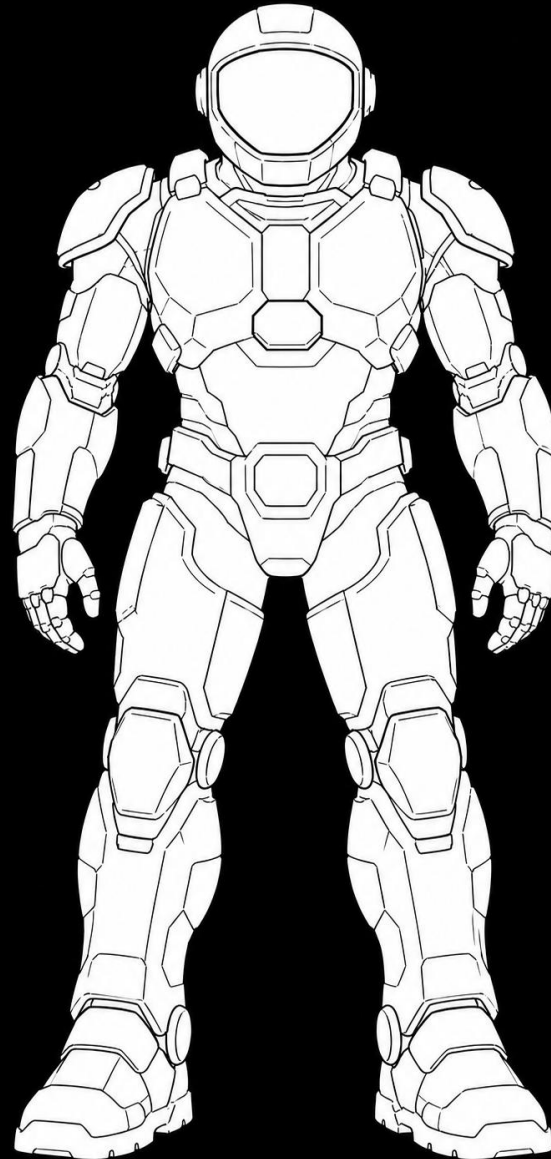
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JUST SUPPORTED.

Whats your suit
look like?

The workbook helps you build it:



Questions?

- Thank you very much!
- Please fill out **eval** here:



Find Slides, resources, a companion workbook, and updates here:



<https://github.com/JRAlexander/surviving-chaos-with-adhd-hacks-devsum-26>

LinkedIn:

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/thejohnalexander>